

CSS BASIC SELECTORS



WHAT DO BASIC SELECTORS DO?

- Basic selectors are patterns used to target and select specific HTML elements on a web page, allowing you to apply CSS styles to those elements
- They are the fundamental mechanism for linking CSS rules to the HTML structure



ELEMENT SELECTOR

- Targets all elements of a specific type
- For example:

```
p { color: black; line-height: 1.6; } h1 { font-size: 2em; } a { text-decoration: none; }
```

- This applies to every matching element on the page



CLASS SELECTOR

- Targets Class with a specific class attribute.
- Classes can be reused on multiple elements

```
<p class="highlight">This paragraph is  
highlighted.</p> <p>This paragraph is not.</p> <p  
class="highlight">This one is also highlighted.</p>
```

```
.highlight { background-color: yellow; font-weight:  
bold; }
```



ID SELECTOR

- Targets a single element with a specific ID
- IDs must be unique on a page

```
#main-header { background-color:  
#333; color: white; padding: 20px; }
```

```
<header id="main-header">  
<h1>My Website</h1> </header>
```



WHEN TO USE IDS VS CLASSES

- Use **classes** for styles that might be reused
- Use **IDs** for unique page elements (headers, main content areas)
- Use **IDs** for JavaScript targeting and anchor links



UNIVERSAL SELECTOR

- Targets **every** element on the page
- Use sparingly as it can impact performance on large pages
- Example:

```
* { margin: 0;  
padding: 0; box-  
sizing: border-  
box; }
```



COMMON MISTAKES

- Forgetting the # for ID selectors
- Forgetting the . For class selectors



GROUPING SELECTORS

- Apply the same styles to multiple selectors:

```
h1, h2, h3, h4, h5, h6 { font-family: Georgia, serif; color: #333; }  
.button, .link, .clickable { cursor: pointer; }
```



CONCLUSION

- Mastering selectors is the foundation for effective styling and specificity

